g) Immunity

While three quarters of individuals over 65 years of age have a decreased capacity to deal with illness such as infection, cancer and degenerative diseases, reminder are as responsive as young adults. Zinc, vitamin A, vitamin C, and folate are the nutrients most often identified with immune function. Although there are few cases of severe defeciencies of these nutrients, prolonges marginal intakes may be a factor in age-related depression of immune function.

h) Cardiovascular disease

Contrary to general opinion hypertension, hypercholesterolemia, glucose intolerance, obesity continue to be factors that increase the risk of cardiovascular disease with advancing age. Also these are not consequences of ageing and are influenced, modified, or delayed by appropriate diet. This usually involves adjusting caloric intake to maintain or achieve normal body weight, adjusting dietary fat, and for hypertension prone individuals, restricting use of discretionary or added salt.

SUMMARY

- Physical strength begins to decline from age 30 to age 80 and above.
- Internal changes refer to the symptoms of growing old that are not visible or obvious.
- Increasing age brings in several problems in vision.
- Loneliness is the feeling of emotional isolation, being locked inside oneself and unable to obtain the warmth and comfort from others.
- Physiological decline in body functions during aging is not uniform.
- Depression can lead to lack of appetite and malnutrition. Being malnourished can also bring on symptoms of depression.
- Many of the elderly are obese. They fail to make adjustments in their energy intake corresponding to decreased energy needs.
- Physical activity of moderate intensity has been recommended for healthy well being.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Coronary heart disease	A disease of the heart due to inadequate blood supply as a resultof narrowing/obstruction of coronary arteries which nourish heart muscle.
Demineralisation	It is a process to reduce the content of mineral substances in tissue or organism, such as bone demineralization.
Parkinson's disease	A disease of the central nervous system that affects movement, often including tremors
Menopause	It is defined as the point in time when menstrual cycles permanently cease due to the natural depletion of ovarian oocytes from aging.
Insomnia	Insomnia is a sleep disorder that is characterized by difficulty falling and\ or staying asleep
Osteo-arthritis	It is the most common chronic (long lasting) joint condition. This can cause pain, stiffness and other symptoms.
Osteoporosis	A condition in which bone become thin, porous and brittle, due to low levels of estrogen. Lack of calcium.

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